

File No 512. Settlement.

Part —

Ser. nos. 1-3.

1922.

Foreign and Political Department.

External.

Pros.

19 , Nos.

13 pages, with Notes.

Subject.

Proposed revision of the classification for purposes of the sea-borne trade relations of the existing two sub-divisions under Arabia viz: (1) Muscat Territory + Trucial Oman + (2) Other Native States in Arabia.

For references to former and later cases see within the cover.

File No. 512. Settlement.

Part —

Ser. nos 1-3.

20.
11/11/22.

References to former cases.

Branch, date and Nos.

Brief title of file.

NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF INDIA

(2)
File No. 512-Ext. (1)

Foreign and Political Department

Ext.(A) Branch.

Proposed revision of the classification for purposes of the sea-borne trade returns of the existing two sub-divisions under Arabia, viz., "Muscat territory and Trucial Oman" and "Other Native States in Arabia".

References.

Copy

Notes

(3)

Subject:- Proposed revision of the classification for the purposes of the Sea-borne trade returns of the existing two sub-division under Arabia viz: (1) Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman and (2) Other Native States in Arabia.

I place below a copy of a letter from the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind, Karachi, No.S.T.227, dated the 24th March, 1922, on the above subject, with a copy of his correspondence with the Political Agent, Muscat. The latter officer suggests:

(1) As "Muscat Territory" and "Trucial Oman" are separate places geographically and politically, it would be preferable to place "Muscat Territory" in one group and include "Trucial Oman" which is a collection of independent Shaikdom in "Other Native States in Arabia".

(2) "Gwadur" which belongs to Muscat should be treated separately like Henjam Island.

3. In this connexion, a reference is invited to Director-General of Commercial Intelligence's U.O. note (Confidential) to the Commerce and Industry Department, No.2377 dated the 30th April, 1913, with which was forwarded a copy of a letter No.2347/1-6 dated the 30th April 1913 to Collectors of Customs conveying instructions for the substitution of "Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman" for "Muscat or Oman" in the list of foreign countries for the Sea-borne Trade of British India. The change was recommended by the Foreign Department at the instance of the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf. The value of India's trade (exclusive of Government stores and treasure) with these countries during the two official years 1919-20 and 1920-21 are stated below:-

	Imports		Exports		Re-exports	
	1919-20 Rs	1920-21 Rs	1919-20 Rs	1920-21 Rs	1919-20 Rs	1920-21 Rs
Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman	50,12,700	51,03,020	68,90,990	76,08,910	50,17,970	49,42,100
Other Native States in Arabia	4,10,260	4,24,280	65,84,180	85,06,390	38,01,530	24,72,100

④
There is no information in this Department as to how much of this trade relates to Trucial Oman only. The present Indian classification agrees closely with the classification in the United Kingdom Trade returns forwarded to this Department with Commerce Department No. 2009 S., dated the 28th September 1921, and it is recommended by the British Empire Statistical Conference in para. 22 of their Report that the Board of Trade Classification should be generally followed. * I States Oct '21, no 1-2

3. There is no objection, however, to show Muscat Territory in one group as recommended by the Political Agent, Muscat, but before making a change a reference seems necessary to the Resident in the Persian Gulf for his opinion as to whether "Trucial Oman" should be shown separately or included in the "Other Native States in Arabia". He may also be asked for a list of ports in Trucial Oman.

4. Gwadar belongs to Muscat. The value of the trade of Gwadar with India is not known in this Department. It is not specified in the United Kingdom List and if Government approve, Gwadar may continue to be included in Muscat Territory.

Sd. D.N.Ghosh

12.4.22.

Department of Commerce U.O.

Through the Director-General
of Commercial Intelligence.

This appears to me a matter on which Foreign and Political Department may wish to consult the Resident.

Sd. C.G.Freke

Calcutta,
The 25th April, 1922.

Offg: Director-General of
Commercial Intelligence.

Commerce Department.

May be passed on to the F. & P. Deptt. as suggested by the D.G., C.I.

Sd. P.M., 3.5.22.

Sd. C.H.B., 3.5.22.

As proposed, we should ask the F. and P. Dept. to
advise

(5)

advise. If the present classification is wrong it would be as well to correct it, though I am inclined to think that we should in that case consult the Board of Trade. The uniformity advocated by the Statistical Conference is of almost greater importance than technical accuracy. It would be useful if the F. and P. Dept. could give us a rough estimate of the amount of trade carried on by the subdivisional groups, - Gwador, for example, is hardly likely to deserve separate record, I should imagine.

Sd. E.C. Ansorge

4.5.22.

3001 EA

For: & Pol: Dept.

This Department is unable to furnish the rough estimate asked for on ^{above} ~~pre~~ page.

2. The Political Agent's suggestion to place "Maskat territory" in one group and "Trucial Oman" under the head "Other Native States in Arabia" may be referred to the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf for his views. Gwador is Maskat territory and it would perhaps be more convenient to retain it under the head "Maskat territory", but we may first see what the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf has to say about it. Draft submitted.

Sd. E.A.R., 11.5.22.

Sd. J.W.E., 13.5.22.

Gwador trade can scarcely be worth showing separately. Issue.

Sd. E.B. Howell
13.5.22.

---(2)---

Letter to the Hon'ble the Pol: Residt: in the Persian Gulf, Bushire, No.504-E.A., dated 17-5-22, asking to be furnished with his views on the proposed revision of classification, for purposes of sea-borne trade returns, of the existing two sub-divisions under Arabia.

215/27
aut 20/5
(3)
Endorsement to the Department of Commerce, No. 553-E.A., dated 26th May 1922, forwarding a copy of the papers cited, for information.

(4)
File No. 512-Ext.
Ly No. 4586-E.A.

Letter from the Hon'ble the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf, Bushire, No. C/256, dated 21st June (recd. 4th July) 1922.

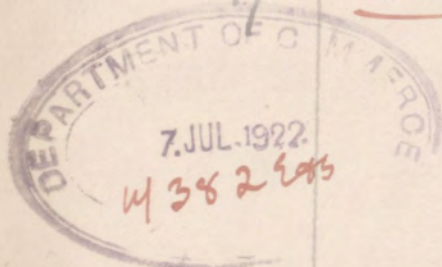
The information was obtained at the request of the Department of Commerce who may now see. This Department may support the Political Resident's views.

E. B. Howell

Cal
5/7/22
18/5/22 6/1

Commerce Dept No. File 512-Ext.

6/7/22



For information. As the present classification agrees with the classification in the U.K.

Trade relations we may also agree with the views of the Political Resident. The Director of Statistics may see.

I agree. D.S. Shone

Sr.

Chusoff

11/7/22

10/7/22
C.B. 10.7.22.

Dir: of Stats: 4/

C.D. U.O. 9. No. 382 Lys 07.11.7.22

F. Stat, Oct 1921, No 1-2, p. 7c, 8th/4



7

Seen and returned with thanks. I have informed the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind, Karachi, accordingly. A copy of the notes may be furnished to this Department for record.

Duly
17-7-22

Department of Commerce U.O.

DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE
21. JUL. 1922
4/352

D.S. J. u/o No 4015 of 17.7.22.

The file may be returned to the D.C. Dept. a copy of relevant papers being kept for the use of this Dept.

Copy supplied to D.S. with 4/42845 27/7

A copy of the notes may also be supplied to the Director of Statistics.

Stansbury
24/7/22

My
22/7/22

D.S. 22.7.22.

For. Col. Dept. 70

C. D. u. o. J. No. 382 of 27.7.22

Notes in the Foreign & Col. Deptt:

(From prepage)

For information. No reply need perhaps be sent to the Results letter

Ead
28/7/22
31/7

31/7

L R Hurrell

amb (3 months)
31/7

(8)

Copy of letter No.S.T./227 of 1922 dated the 24th March, 1922, from the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind, to the Director of Statistics, Calcutta.

I have the honour to enclose a copy of the correspondence which has taken place between this Office and that of the Political Agent, Muscat, regarding a suggestion made by the Political Agent to alter the classification of the existing two groups of countries under Arabia viz (1) Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman and (2) Other Native States in Arabia. This Office has no objection to adopt the Political Agent's proposal to exclude 'Trucial Oman' from group (1) and include it in groupe (2). If the proposed change is approved by you I shall be obliged if you will be so good as to furnish me with a list of the names of the principal ports to be included in each of the two new groups. A list of the names of the principal ports classified in this Office under the existing two groups is attached with this Office letter No.S.T./227, dated 20-2-1922 to the Political Agent Muscat, a copy of which is enclosed. The Political Agent in his letter No.403 dated 14-3-1922 suggests that "Gwadur" should be shown separately like Henjam Island and Dabai and Shargah which are ports in Trucial Oman should be included in the proposed group (2). I shall be obliged if you will be so good as to let me know whether you approve of these changes.

Enclosures to the above.

Copy of letter No.225 dated 15-2-1922 from the Political Agent, Muscat, to the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind.

"In the annual statement of the Trade and Navigation of the Province of Sind for 1920-21 I notice that "Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman" are placed in one statistical group and "Other Native States in Arabia" in another. This classification is perhaps an old one and it may be inconvenient to alter it, but it appears to be wrong one. "Muscat Territory

9
Territory" and "Trucial Oman" are separate places Geographically and Politically and are not connected in Trade. It would therefore be preferable to place "Muscat Territory" in one group and include "Trucial Oman", which is a collection of independent Shaikdoms, in "Other Native States in Arabia".

Copy of letter No.S.T./227 dated 28-2-1922 from the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind, to the Political Agent and H.M's Consul, Muscat.

"With reference to your letter No. 225 dated the 15th instant, I have the honour to state that the classification of the different countries appearing in the Annual Statement of the Trade and Navigation of the Province of Sind published by this Office is prescribed by the Director of Statistics with the Government of India, Calcutta, and therefore the proposal made by you will be forwarded to that officer for disposal on your furnishing me with a list of the principal ports you propose to include in the groups 'Muscat Territory (excluding Trucial Oman)' and 'Other Native States in Arabia (including Trucial Oman)'. I enclose a list of the names of the principal ports classified in this Office under the present two groups viz : 'Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman' and 'Other Native States in Arabia' for your information".

List of the Names of the principal ports.

Muscat Territory and Trucial Oman.

1. Muscat
2. Gwadar
3. Dabai
4. Shargah
5. Soor
6. Musna

Other Native States in Arabia.

1. Koweit
2. Makallah
3. Shahoti
4. Sihat
5. Katar
6. Sheher
7. Jeddah
8. Hodeida
9. Elkatif.

Copy of letter No.403 dated 14-3-1922 from the Political Agent, Muscat, to the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind.

(12) (8)

"In reply to your letter No. S.T./227 of 28th February 1922 I have the honour to say that Muscat Territory extends from about Ras Sajar on the South-East of Arabia opposite Soqatrah to a short distance within the entrance to the Persian Gulf. Its main ports from south to north are --

Murbat
Sur
Qariyat
Muscat
Matrah
Sib
Barkah
Masnaah
Suwaiq
Kabura
Saham
Sohar
Lima *Liwa?*
Shinas
Khasab

At all these except Morbat the Muscat Government maintains Customs posts.

Gwador belongs to Muscat but its trade is quite separate, and it would be convenient if it could be treated separately like Henjam Island.

Dabai and Shargah are in Trucial Oman.

I have no official connection with Trucial Oman or "Other Native States in Arabia" but may perhaps be permitted to suggest that the present grouping together of such diverse and widely separated entities makes the statistics of very little use. It is beyond my province to suggest any method of re-grouping. The matter concerns the Residents in the Persian Gulf and at Aden".

Copy of U.O.No.2377 dated the 30th April 1913 (Confidential) from the D.G.C.I., Calcutta, to the Department of Commerce and Industry, Simla.

"I am giving effect to the recommendations of the Foreign Department. A copy of my letter No.2347/1-6 conveying the requisite instructions to the Collectors of Customs is placed on file. As regards para 5 of the notes dated 13th March 1913 in the Foreign Department (on page 2 of these notes), I would suggest that "Gwador" as printed under Persia in the Karachi

Collector's

9 (11)
Collector's letter No.S/1127 dated the 9th December, 1912 to the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf is a misprint for "Gwatur" (Gwator or Gwettar)".

Copy of letter No.2347/1-6 dated the 30th April 1913 from the D.G.C.I, Calcutta, to the Collectors of Customs, Calcutta and Bombay, the Chief Collector of Customs in Sind, the Collector of Customs, Madras, the Chief Collector of Customs, Burma and the Collector of Customs, Balasore.

In continuation of this Department letter No.4147 dated the 28th

the 28th July, 1911, I have the honour to request that No.3455 dated 21-6-1912, I have the honour to request that "Maskat Territory and Trucial Oman may be substituted for "Muscat or Oman" in the revised list of foreign countries for the Sea-borne trade of British India forwarded therewith. I have also to state that the trade with "Kuwait" (Koweit) should, in future, be included with that of "Other Native States in Arabia" instead of with "Asiatic Turkey - Persian Gulf" (in supersession of the instructions conveyed in my letter No.806 dated the 7th February, 1910), and that the trade with the Island of ⁸¹⁰Henjam may be excluded from that of Persia and the Island may be treated as a separate country in the returns of the foreign sea-borne trade.

11/12/1910
To Calcutta and Madras only.

For and Pol DEPARTMENT. (2) (12)

E (A) BRANCH.

File No.

Serial No.

General, Diary or Regr. } No. 3001-L.A.
No. of letter replied to }

Whether a reply is } Yes.
required or not }

List of Enclosures As indicated below.

HEADING-

No. 504 E.X.H.

Sinla 7th May 1922

To

The Hon'ble the Pol. Residt. in the
Persian Gulf, Bushire.

Subject - Proposed revision of the class-
ification for purposes of the sea-borne
trade returns of the existing two sub-
divisions under Arabia, viz., "Maskat
territory & Trucial Oman" and "Other
Native States in Arabia."

Sir,

I am directed to enclose a copy of
Letter from the Collector of Customs in Sind, to the Director of Statistics
in Calcutta, No. S.T/227, dated 24th March
1922 and enclosures.
the correspondence marginally cited and
to request that the Government of India
may be furnished at an early date with
your views on the proposal, together with
a rough estimate of the amount of trade
carried on by the sub-divisional groups.

I have &c.,

A. B. Howells

D.S. (T)

Proceedings for

No.

S. 6.

General Diary or
Regr. No. of
letter replied to

By ho 300/9a

Issue
23/5

For Pol:

DEPARTMENT.

2/9)

Branch.

Heading.

Mr Reed
27/5

File No.

Serial No.

No. 553

Re.

Simla, 26th May 1922

A copy of the undermentioned ^{letter} papers is forwarded to the Deptt. of Commerce, for information.

By order, etc.,

J. B. Howell

Deputy Secretary (7)

Particulars for guidance of Copyist,
Despatcher or Issue Branch.

List of Papers forwarded.

Letter to the Pol: Residt. in the Persian
Gulf, Bushire, ho 504-Exd, 9/17-5-22

Pros.

S. 8.

Nos.

12
4
14
No. C/ 256 of 1922.

British Residency and Consulate-General,

Bushire, 21st June 1922.

FOR
Recd 14 922
File 5/281
Serial No
Diary No 4586 EA

From

The Hon'ble Lieut-Colonel, A.P. Trevor, C.S.I.,
C.I.E.
Political Resident in the Persian Gulf.

To

Denys de S. Bray Esquire, C.S.I., C.I.E., C.B.E.,
Foreign Secretary to the Government of India,
in the Foreign and Political Department.

S I M L A.

Subject- Proposed revision of the classification for
purposes of the sea-borne trade returns of the existing
two sub-divisions under Arabia, viz., "Muscat territory
and Trucial Oman" and "Other Native States in Arabia".

Sir,

✓ Ser(2)
I have the honour to refer you to your No. 504 Ext.
dated 17th May 1922 and enclosures.

The classification for the groups under discussion
are simply for convenience of classification of trade i.e.
imports into and exports from British possessions and
the question of jurisdiction is only a minor point. For
this reason I consider the present classification the
most convenient and would recommend that it should stand.
The only point to be remembered is that if the Chief
Collector of Customs or any other official desires
information about Trucial Oman he should write to the
Political Resident in the Persian Gulf and not to the
Political Agent, Muscat.

As regards Gwadar I consider that it should remain
as part of Oman as long as it belongs to Muscat and I
do not consider it is necessary to classify it separately.

With regard to the last para of your letter the

(13)



volume of trade of Muscat in 1919-20 was

Imports £. 260,752

Exports £. 314,851

No figures having any degree of accuracy are available for the Trucial coast, where a large part of the Trade is carried on by dhow. There are no particulars obtainable as to the volume of trade at any of these "Other Native States of Arabia" except for Bahrein and Koweit where there is a Political Agent and annual trade reports are compiled. The volume of trade at these places according to the last returns was

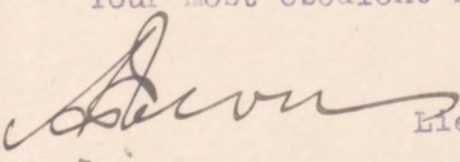
	BAHREIN	KOWEIT.
	1919-20	1920-21
Imports	£. 1414423	£ 634268
Exports	£. 946344	£ 446398

It is impossible to get any details from Qatar and Nejd as all the sea-borne trade is carried on in dhows. of which there is no check at all.

I have the honour to be,

Sir,

Your most obedient servant,


Lieut-Colonel,
Political Resident in the Persian Gulf.